

Fortune or Death!

Crows is unfair. It doesn't care about your character's level. Charge at a behemoth without a good plan to take it down, and you're probably going to end up as a puddle of gore. This game's math hasn't been balanced to ensure players win most of the time.

But the unfairness goes both ways. Come with a clever plan to defeat that behemoth, like dropping the cave ceiling on their head while they slumber, and you can win the day without a fight. A good plan or clever thinking won't just save your life, it'll get you paid—and that's the whole point. Your life will be easier and you'll still get the gold and the XP if you can just sneak by that behemoth with your pockets full of coins.

In *Crows*, the players create adventurers in a desolate world who dive into horror-infested ruins for gold, gems, and other treasures. Sure, these adventurers occasionally perform courageous, selfless acts and might be moral people, but they aren't heroes. It's greed, thrill-seeking, or lack of other ways to make a living that drives them into the dark where gold and ravenous eyes gleam in the torchlight. It's a risky job—surviving a dungeon takes strength, smarts, and reflexes. Coming out a little richer than you were going in also takes luck.

The rules of *Crows* are inspired by some incredible games that are also worth your time and money. Check out *Apocalypse World*, *The Black Hack*, *Cairn*, *Knave*, *Mausritter*, *Shadowdark*, and *Troika*!

Cornath Optional

The rules refer to the land of Cornath, the campaign setting where the dungeons included with *Crows* are set. The Ref can use just the rules of this game to create their own monsters, dungeons, items, traits, backgrounds, and campaign setting and ignore the lore of Cornath.

Playtest Material

This is playtest material that has yet to be edited or properly laid out. Give us your feedback on the game in our playtest survey here: <https://forms.gle/VyEqwYKGiiZ5QBxc6>

Welcome to Cornath

Cornath wasn't always this way. Marigolds bloomed in fall, winters were mild, songbirds twittered in spring, and summers passed hot and pleasant. The Archmages ruled together, using magic to ensure their people would prosper. These same leaders tore Cornath asunder.

For all their knowledge, the Archmages failed to see that magic, the stuff of chaos, was sentient. Tired of being used by the Archmages, magic retaliated, causing tragedy for each. The Archmages reached too far, using magic to correct their errors until chaos poisoned their souls and made them wicked.

As greed and suspicion shrank their hearts, the Archmages raised armies of the dead, summoned monsters from other worlds, and twisted animals and plants to create hungry amalgamations. Their forces warred, uncaring for the innocent people caught in a tide of blood. The powerful spells of the Archmages suffused the land with a toxic fog that turns good folk cruel. The people gave their leaders a new name—Necromancers.

Fifty years ago the war began. Ten years ago, the Necromancers disappeared, but their beasts remain. Survivors, who huddled together in ruins during the war to keep monsters at bay, ventured into the Miasma to find others. Humans reconnected and renewed trade. The roads are overgrown and perilous, but the chance to make coin has merchants traveling and gave rise to the crows—scavengers brave or foolish enough to pick over the bones of the dead in monster-infested holes. The crows hope that each new ruin they enter holds wealth waiting to be unveiled by torchlight. Many find only death.

Amaryll

Amaryll the Generous, virtuoso with elemental magic, created spells that helped control the weather and grow crops. To feed an expanding populace, she cast a spell to make the sun shine with greater nourishment. The magic failed, scorching crops. To make up for the shortage, she created new supernatural plants ... that were more interested in eating humans than being food. Amaryll didn't see their creation as a blunder, but rather as an improvement over humans. Her monsters were evolved creature who deserved to inherit the earth from humans.

Craelin

Craelin the Clever, master of alteration magic, created spells to shape the lands and enhance the construction of Cornath's buildings. While raising a wall to protect Elsgeth City, his spell caused a massive earthquake. Desperate to make up for his folly, Craelin searched for survivors but found only corpses. He vowed to give these remains new life. Twisting their flesh with that of living animals, Craelin created the blood monsters, unnaturally transmuted creatures who hunger for human flesh. Craelin believes the other Archmages engineered Elsgeth's fall.

Ithnagio

Ithnagio the Curious, authority on conjuration magic, created spells for teleportation and to bring forth helpful creatures. While crafting a spell, Ithnagio sent his notes into Hell. He tried to bring them back but instead conjured demons. Ithnagio found he could command the evil fiends like other summons. He continued to conjure them, unaware their presence corrupted his soul.

Ornassa

Ornassa the Wise, expert in benefaction magic, created spells to heal Cornath's sick and injured. Her brother, Malek, fell ill, and no spell in her library could save him. When all seemed lost, new spells stirred in her mind. Malek became the first of many undead creatures under her command. To her, necromancy was a chance to reunite people with their loved ones ... more powerful than any benefaction spell, for it could reverse even death. Ornassa believed the other Necromancers were behind her brother's death.

Zaziel

Zaziel the Cunning, specialist in illusion magic, created spells to entertain Cornath. The last of the Necromancers to fall, Zaziel prayed to the gods for a way to save their former allies, enacting a great illusory performance meant to move the divine into action. Those illusions came to life, beautiful tangible beings that Zaziel called angels, for the mage believed they were servants of the gods. Every illusion cast brought forth a new angel, and soon Zaziel had an army and a plan. They alone must rule Cornath.

The Gods

While the people of Cornath revered the Archmages as leaders, they worshipped an even higher power—the gods. Though each god has priests dedicated to their service, most folk in Cornath pray to all five at some point throughout the day—the Gardner for good weather or harvest, the Barber to remove a loved one's ailments, the Smith for inspiration, the Warrior for protection, and the Three for knowledge, wealth, or easy passage into death. The Archmages saw priests as valuable leaders of their communities, so they gave them spells that reflected the gods' most virtuous values.

The Gardner

Depicted as a rabbit, the Gardner is the god of animals, plants, weather, and natural phenomenon. Priests of the Gardner often wear clothing of green and offer blessings at farms.

The Healer

Depicted as a leech, the Healer's domains are health and medicine. Priests of the Healer wear red, heal the injured and sick, and deliver babies.

The Smith

Depicted as a beaver, the Smith is the god of creativity. The Smith's priests bless forges, musical instruments, paints, and all manner of tools and artisans. These gold-robed priests curate and display great works of art in temples.

The Warrior

Depicted as a wolf, the Warrior is the god of battle. The Warrior's priests wear blue and bless weapons, armor, and soldiers and often take on important roles in a town's militia.

The Three

Depicted as three-headed crow, the Three is the god of death, greed, and knowledge. The Three's priests conduct funeral services and maintain temple libraries. They provide services of interest to crows, using magic to retrieve items lost in dungeons and exchanging unwanted treasures for more useful stuff. The Three's priests uniquely use necromancy magic, believing it is the wielder and not the art that makes a practice evil.

Players and the Ref

Most of the players in this game create and control an adventurer, called a crow or player character (PC for short). The *Player's Guide* has rules for making crows. The crows work together to obtain loot by delving into monster-infested ruins. These crows are from the same village, and the spoils they bring back allow them to turn their small town into a bustling fortress.

One player is the Referee or Ref. They don't play a crow. Instead, they control all the monsters, other characters (called nonplayer characters or NPCs), and environments that come into contact with the crows. The Ref also serves as the interpreter and adjudicator of the game's rules. They aren't adversarial, even though they control the crows' adversaries. Refs are impartial judges, hence the name.

To play the game, the Ref sets the scene whenever the PCs enter a new place or a new event occurs. Then the players tell the Ref what their crows do in the scene. The Ref decides if the PCs' actions require any tests and then interprets and narrates the outcome of their actions. Rinse and repeat.

The Ref is a player of the game, but from here on out whenever the rules refer to "players," we mean the ones controlling individual crows and not the Ref to avoid confusion.

Playing the Game

If you're a player controlling a crow, you should keep the following in mind as you play:

- **Death is on the table.** The odds are against you, so don't get too attached to your PC, and if they die, that's just part of the fun of the game. You'll have a good story to tell. That's what RPGs are all about. If you want to minimize risk of death, approach obstacles with caution.
- **Enter the dungeon.** Caution is a crow's friend. Inaction is the enemy. Standing still or checking every inch of a dungeon for traps wastes time and resources. Go slow and you will face a wandering monster as your torch burns out.
- **Think outside your character sheet.** If you approach problems logically and creatively, you might overcome them without needing to make a test at all.

Running the Game

The Ref role is a rewarding and entirely different experience from the players in *Crows*. You control how the NPCs, monsters, and world react to the PCs' actions. As you run *Crows*, here are some tips to keep in mind that will make your game more enjoyable for you and the players:

- **Let logic and creativity win.** When the crows plan and take actions that should allow them to overcome obstacles with ease, award their forethought and ingenuity with success. There's always one more monster or hazard in the next chamber to challenge them and keep them on their toes.
- **Not every action needs a test.** If a PC attempts an action that would work more than 80 percent of the time in real life, then allow them to succeed without rolling dice. If they have lots of time to overcome a task and failure in the attempt it has no consequence, they can tackle the issue without a test.
- **Hint at danger.** If the players think every square in the dungeon is a potential pit trap and that monsters lurk in every shadow, they're going to move slowly through the dungeon as they poke and prod every surface with a 10-foot pole. The game moves faster and is more fun for everyone if you telegraph when danger is ahead. A headless corpse lying in a hallway indicates the corridor might be trapped. A rotten stench seeping from under a door hints at undead on the other side. Players learn to look for these signs and when they should be on high alert, rather than constant vigilance. If they ignore the warning signs, that's on them.
- **Play the dice where they fall.** It's often best if you roll your dice in front of the players rather than in secret, because it will hold you accountable to the results. Monsters don't pull their punches. Traps are indifferent to the feelings of those who trigger them. The world of *Crows* is unforgiving, and you play the world. You should be strict but fair in your judgments. You don't need to fudge the rules in favor of the crows. They know the risks.
- **If it's fun, then it's right.** As long as you and your players are having fun playing *Crows*, then you're playing it right. Change any rules or details you like to suit your group.

Dice

This game uses ten-sided dice (also called d10s). Each player and the Ref should have two of these. The game also makes use of six-sided dice (d6s). Everyone should have a few of those too.

To roll a d100, grab 2d10. One die represents the tens digit, with the other die represents the ones digit. A 10 counts as 0, unless both dice rolled are 10, then the number rolled is 100.

Game of Exceptions

This game has a fair number of rules. It also has plenty of character options, specialized equipment, and other game elements that let you break those rules. Breaking the rules makes players feel special and their foes feel dangerous.

If you're not sure what to do when two rules come into conflict with each other, a specific exception always beats a more general rule. The Ref has the final say in how rules are adjudicated.

Always Round Down

Sometimes the rules tell you to divide a number in half or by another measurement. Whenever you divide and it results in a decimal, round the result down to the nearest whole number.

Creature and Object

This game uses the terms "creature" and "object" when referring to the targets of attacks, spells, and other effects. Creatures are living or unliving beings such as animals, humans, and undead. Objects are inanimate matter such as torches, ropes, and swords.

When a creature dies, their body becomes an object, and is affected by rules as an object, not a creature. If a spell targets a creature, it can't be used to target an inanimate corpse.

The game sometimes refers to "unattended objects," which are objects that aren't held, worn, or controlled by a creature. Whenever an rule targets objects, it affects only unattended objects unless the Ref determines otherwise.

You don't have to worry about effects dealing damage to ceilings, floors, walls, buildings, caves, or other structures unless the rules specifically call it out.

Characteristics

Every creature in the game, including each PC, has three characteristics:

- **Agility (A):** Agility represents a creature's coordination and nimbleness. It's used for dodging, attacking with ranged and light weapons, acrobatics, sneaking, and thievery.
- **Mind (M):** Mind represents a creature's mental acuity. It's used to resist mind-bending magic, cast spells, notice hidden or secret things, or recall lore.
- **Strength (S):** Strength represents might and brawn. It's used for resisting poison and forceful effects, making melee attacks, climbing, jumping, lifting, swimming, and throwing.

Each characteristic has a score between -5 and 5. The higher your score, the better you are at the things that characteristic represents. PCs start with a score of -1, 0, or 1 in each of these characteristics. The highest score a PC can have in a characteristic without magic help is 3.

No Interaction Characteristic

You may have played some games where there have been rules that govern and statistics for social interaction between the player character and NPCs. Social interaction isn't a focus of this game—many of an crow's foes can't or don't want to be reasoned with. We didn't want to create a lot of social interaction skills and traits that people would take for their characters and then end up not using. When there is a scene of social interaction, that scene can be played out with the adventurers and NPCs talking normally. The Ref decides if any persuading, bribes, lies, threats, blackmail, quid pro quo, or other techniques of influence and manipulation would work on the NPC or not based on the NPCs' personality. If the Ref really wants the dice to decide if a PC can outwit an NPC, they can call for a Mind test.

Magic and Mundane

The word "magic" describes creatures, objects, and effects that are magical in nature. The word "mundane" describes creatures, objects, and effects that aren't magic.

Tests

Whenever a crow performs a risky task with a reasonable chance of failure, the Ref should call for a test. If there's no reasonable chance of failure (e.g. a PC attempts to tie a simple knot with zero time pressure), the Ref shouldn't have the player make a test. If there's no chance of success (e.g. a PC attempts to hold their breath for an hour), the Ref shouldn't have the player make a test and simply describe the consequences of such an outrageous action. If it's the kind of task that would definitely result in a PC's death, the Ref should first ask the player if they're sure they want to try something that would spell their demise before they undertake the task. The Ref should make it clear the task will 100% result in bad shit happening. If the player still wants to do it, that's on them.

Clever actions taken to overcome obstacles don't require a test. They just work.

Making a Test

When the Ref decides a test is in order, the player rolls 2d10 and adds one of their crow's characteristic that the Ref deems applies to the task. If the PC attempts to sneak by a distracted monster, the test uses Agility. If they try to determine the nature of a magic glyph, the test uses Mind. If they attempt to lift an iron portcullis, the test uses Strength.

If the rules call for a test and present multiple characteristics to choose from, the creature making the test chooses which to use.

Skills

Skills represent a crow's specific areas of expertise. When you make a test, you can add one (and only one) applicable skill's bonus to the test if you have it. A starting PC's skills all have a bonus of +1, which can increase to +2 as part of the crow's advancement.

There are three categories of skills: general, spellcasting, and weapon. General skills apply to tests that are used in exploration, investigation, and crafting. Spellcasting skills are only used in castings, and weapon skills are only used in weapon attacks (see [Special Tests](#)). At the Ref's discretion, these skills could apply to other tests, such as identifying a spell cast by an enemy or determining the properties of a magic weapon.

General Skills

Skill	Use
Alchemy	Make and know about potions, poisons, and bombs
Blacksmithing	Make and know about metal tools, armor, and weapons
Climb	Move up vertical surfaces
Enchanting	Make and know about magic items
Endurance	Remain engaged in strenuous activity for a long time period
Gymnastics	Move across unsteady or narrow surfaces; tumble
Handle Animal	Interact with domesticated animals
Hide	Conceal yourself from others
Historical Lore	Know about significant past events
Jump	Leap vertically or horizontally
Lift	Pick up, carry, and throw heavy objects
Magic Lore	Know about magical places, spells, items, and phenomena
Monster Lore	Know monster ecology, strengths, and weaknesses
Nature Lore	Know about natural flora, fauna, and weather
Navigate	Travel without getting lost
Pick Lock	Open a lock without the key
Religious Lore	Know about religious mythology and practices
Sabotage	Disable a mechanical device
Search	Search an environment for important details and items
Sleight of Hand	Conceal or steal an item without another noticing
Sneak	Move silently
Swim	Move through deep liquid

Tests Equations

Tests are often presented in the rules by telling you to roll 2d10 + a characteristic. Sometimes they also tell you which skill to include. If a skill isn't included, it doesn't mean a skill can't apply to the roll (unless it is a resistance roll).

Spellcasting Skills

Skill	Use
Alteration	Cast alteration spells
Benefaction	Cast benefaction spells
Conjuration	Cast conjuration spells
Elemental	Cast elemental spells
Illusion	Cast illusion spells
Necromancy	Cast necromancy spells

Weapon Skills

Skill	Use
Bashing	Attack with bashing weapons
Bow	Attack with bow weapons
Chopping	Attack with chopping weapons
Slashing	Attack with slashing weapons
Stabbing	Attack with stabbing weapons
Unarmed	Attack with natural weapons

By design, some skills have expertises that overlap. It's plausible that three different people—one an expert in blacksmithing, one an expert in magic item enchantment, and one an expert in magical lore—could all have a decent change at identifying the properties of a magic sword.

It's not up to the Ref to know every skill a PC has. When the Ref calls for a test, they should tell the player which characteristic to use. If the player feels their PC has a skill that applies to the test, they can tell the Ref. If it's not obvious why the skill applies, the player should make an argument for why. If the Ref agrees, the skill applies. If they disagree, it doesn't.

Approaching a problem creatively helps you get the most out of your skills. Climb is the obvious choice for a test made to move up and over a wall, but if you balance a board diagonally on the ground to make a ramp, you might use Gymnastics instead.

Circumstantial Modifiers

Environmental factors can influence a test's chance of success. A PC attempting to lift a heavy chest has a harder time if the chest submerged in mud or an easier time if it is submerged in water. The Ref can grant a test a +1 bonus for each significant environmental advantage and a -1 penalty for each disadvantage.

Test Results

If the result of the test is 11 or lower, it's a tier 1 result. This result means that you didn't do what you set out to do, and at the Ref's discretion you might suffer a setback. It depends upon the nature of the test. Failing to recall lore about a god results in no consequences, while failing to jump over a pit of acid means you're going for a sizzling swim. In the case of casting some spells, a tier 1 result still accomplishes something, because the tier 1 result of spells always have a cost.

If the result of the test is 12 to 16, it's a tier 2 result. This result means you either partially, but not fully, accomplish your task or succeed fully at a cost. The Ref decides the outcome. If you get a tier 2 result while attempting to sneak by a monster, a partial result would be that you successfully sneaks halfway to your destination, but fail to make it out of danger, and need to continue rolling to sneak. If the Ref decides instead it makes more sense for you to succeed at a cost, you get to their destination without being noticed but drop a piece of equipment on the ground on the way.

If the result of the test is a 17 or higher, it's a tier 3 result. This means you do what you set out to do without any complication.

Crits and Dooms

When the dice without any modifiers equal a 19 or 20, the result of the test is a critical success (or crit). When you get a crit, you get a tier 3 result plus a bit extra, which could be due to your great skill or a lucky break. If you achieve a crit while searching a chest for traps, you find and disarm any traps without another test. A crit while climbing a cliff might mean you can carry an ally who then doesn't need to make the test.

When the dice without any modifiers equal a 2 or a 3, the test result is a doom. You automatically gets a tier 1 result and suffers a major setback. A doom while searching a chest for traps means you triggered the trap automatically suffers the brunt of it without a chance to dodge the danger. Doom on a test to climb a cliff means you climb to the top of the cliff and then fall.

Unless otherwise noted, the Ref decides the exact outcome of crits and dooms.

Trying Again

When you fail a test, you can't attempt it again unless the circumstances of the test significantly change. If you attempt an Agility test to pick a lock and fail, you can't attempt to pick the lock again unless you get better lockpicks, oil the lock, or the like. The Ref decides when circumstances have changed enough for a new attempt.

Special Tests

There are three special kinds of tests.

Assists

An assist is a test you make to aid another creature with a different test. You must make the assist before the other test. You might make a Strength test to give another PC a boost while they attempt to climb up a cliff or make a Mind test to distract an enemy and give an ally a bonus on an attack. The test has these outcomes.

<11 The assisted test takes a -1 penalty.

12-16 The assisted test gains a +1 bonus.

17+ The assisted test gains a +2 bonus.

Generally, if the test you're assisting doesn't happen within 1 combat turn of the assist, any bonus applied to it by the assist disappears.

When you make an assist in combat, you must use your maneuver if the test you assist requires a maneuver or your action if it requires an action or reaction.

Attacks

Attacks are tests made by a creature when they intend to deal damage to another creature or an object. The results of an attack, including crits and doom, are specified by the rules and the spell or weapon used to make them. Only spellcasting and weapon skills can be applied to attacks. See [Combat](#) for more.

Castings

Castings are tests made to cast a spell from a spellbook. The results of a casting, including crits and doom, are specified by the rules and the spell used to make them. Only spellcasting skills can be applied to castings. See [Spellcasting](#) for more.

Some castings are also attacks. The rules of castings and attacks apply to them.

Resistance Rolls

Resistance rolls (RR) are tests a creature makes in response to danger, such as an explosion, mind-warping magic, or poison. An effect that forces a resistance roll provides its tier results. Skills can't be applied to RRs.

A crit on an RR could allow a creature to get a chance to harm the creature or object forcing the roll (similar to a counter; see [Combat](#)) or provide an automatic tier 3 result for an ally making the same test. A doom result could mean that the creature making the roll takes 1d10 damage in addition to any other harm imposed by the result.

Hide and Sneak

You can only make a test to hide from a creature if they aren't observing you. If you try to sneak by a creature, you must move at half your speed or slower or take a -2 penalty on the test. While you are hidden from another creature, you gain a +2 bonus on attacks against them, and they take a -2 penalty on RRs imposed by you. If you're hidden and take aggressive action, a creature notices you.

Inventory Slots

The number of items you can carry is represented by your inventory slots. Every PC has 2 hand slots, 2 belt slots, and 10 backpack slots, numbered 1 to 10. A PC can wear an outfit of clothes (but not armor) and a backpack without those items taking up slots.

Many items, such as a shield, a sword, or a crowbar, take up a single inventory slot. Other items, such as a ladder or a suit of heavy armor, take up more than one inventory slot. The inventory slots these items take up must always be of the same type and must be next to each other. You can't carry a 10-foot pole with one hand slot and one belt slot, and you can't place your 10-foot pole in backpack slots 2 and 7.

There are several items that can be stacked in a single inventory slot. One inventory slot can hold 5 potions, 3 locks, or 2 flasks of lantern oil. You can only stack items of the same kind in one inventory slot, though these items don't have to be exactly the same. You can stack up to 5 different potions together in one slot, but you can't stack 3 potions and 2 locks together. Each hand can only hold one item at a time, so you can't stack items in hand slots.

Magic Item Slots

You have six other slots that can be used to wear magic items. You have a head slot for circlets, crowns, and hats, a neck slot for amulets, cloaks, and necklaces, a waist slot for magic belts and girdles, an arms slot for magic bracers and gloves, a finger slot for rings, and a feet slot for boots and shoes. If a magic item must occupy a magic item slot to be used, the item's card informs you.

If you have more than one magic item equipped in the same slot, so much chaos on one place on your body takes a toll and doesn't allow you to rest. When you equip a second or greater item in a slot and at the end of each DT you have two or more items in a slot, you gain 1d6 wounds.

Item Cards

You track of your equipment using the item cards and inventory sheet that come with this game. You can use the digital files of this game to print as many cards and sheets as you need.

Each piece of equipment is represented by a card. If a piece of equipment takes up two slots, you can lay it horizontally to indicate the number of slots it takes up. If it takes up 1 slot, then place it vertically on the sheet. You can keep track of magic effects or the number of an item that you have in a stack by putting the card in a plastic card sleeve and writing on the card in dry erase marker, or write directly on a card you print out.

The cards can be placed on the sheet, or you can arrange them without a sheet by placing your item cards in four rows: the top row contains the cards in your hand slots, the middle row is your belt slot cards, and the bottom two rows are your backpack slot cards (5 slots per backpack row).

Wearing Armor

You can choose one suit of armor (not a shield) in your backpack slots to be the armor you currently wear. You can only don a new armor when you are not in a situation tracked in combat rounds.

Equipped Items

Aside from magic items worn in slots and suits of armor, to use any other item, including a weapon, tool, light source, or spellbook, the item must first be placed in a hand slot. Items in hand slots are equipped and being wielded.

Swapping Slots

When you aren't in combat or some other situation tracked in combat rounds, you can freely switch items between slots. When you are in a situation tracked in combat rounds, you need to use a maneuver (see [Combat](#)) to rearrange your hand slots and belt slots with each other. As part of this maneuver, you can freely drop any item you're holding or wearing on your belt.

If you want to grab an item from your backpack when time is tracked in combat rounds, you need to use a maneuver and then declare the item you want from your backpack. Then roll 1d10. If the result is equal to or higher than at least one of the backpack slots of the item you declared, you draw out the item and can swap it and any items in your hand slots, or drop the items in your hand slots and move the item from your backpack slots into your hand slots. If the number you rolled is lower, you can rearrange the items in your backpack, but you can't take anything out. You can only grab one backpack item at a time.

You can drop any number of items from your backpack onto the ground as a maneuver.

Damage and Death

Every creature in the game has a measure of vitality called Stamina. Some creatures also have an Armor Defense (AD) and all PCs also measure vitality in wounds taken. Damage is sometimes abbreviated as "dam" in test results.

Armor Defense

Every suit of armor and shield has an AD. When a creature wearing armor or wielding shield takes damage, it subtracted from their armor's AD. If a creature has more than one source of AD (such as a worn suit of armor and shield), they choose which item first loses AD while taking damage. When an item's AD drops to 0, the item can no longer be used to stop damage. A PC can restore one item's AD as a rest activity (see [Resting](#)).

Piercing Damage

Some damage is designated as piercing, with a P next to the damage amount. This damage ignores AD and is subtracted from a creature's Stamina first and then grants wounds if the creature's Stamina is 0.

Stamina

When a creature's AD is 0, the damage they take is subtracted from their Stamina. When a Ref-controlled creature's Stamina is 0, they die. If you reduce a Ref-controlled creature to 0 Stamina, you can ask the Ref if the damage could instead knock the creature unconscious. If the Ref says it's okay, then the creature is reduced to 1 Stamina instead of 0 and regains consciousness at the end of the dungeon turn.

Objects have Stamina and are destroyed when it reaches 0. They can take damage, but can't gain conditions or other effects.

WOUNDS

When a PC (or a hireling or pet) takes damage and their AD and Stamina are 0, they take 1 wound for every 1 damage they take. Each wound they take fills up a backpack slot of the PC's choice. For each slot occupied by a wound and an item, your speed is reduced by 1 (to a minimum of 0). When all of a creature's backpack slots have wounds, they die.

CONDITIONS

Conditions are temporary status effects that can harm or help a creature. Except for boned and blessed, you can only be under the effect of one instance of a condition at a time. If you gain a condition you already have, the new version ends the previous, including duration and any secondary effects associated with the condition.

Blessed

Your blessed level begins at 0. Each time you are blessed, your blessed level increases by 1. You gain a cumulative +1 bonus to all tests and deal a cumulative +1 damage with all attacks for each blessed level you have. Your blessed level becomes 0 at the end of a dungeon turn.

BONED

Your boned level begins at 0. Each time you are boned, your boned level increases by 1. You gain a cumulative -1 penalty to all tests and when you take damage, you take additional damage equal to each boned level you have. Your boned level becomes 0 at the end of a dungeon turn.

Blessed and Boned

The levels of blessed and boned cancel each other out 1 to 1. If you are blessed 2 and boned 3, you are effectively boned 1.

Grabbed

You can be grabbed by a creature, effect, or object. While you are grabbed, your speed is 0 and attacks against you gain a +1 bonus. If your grabber moves, you move with them. If the grabber is your size or smaller, their speed is halved while they have you grabbed. The grabber can use a maneuver to change your position relative to them, as long as you remain within range of the effect that grabbed you relative to the grabber's current position.

If the grabber moves further away from you than the range of the effect that grabbed you, you are no longer grabbed. The grab ends if the grabber willingly lets go or is killed, prone, or unconscious. You can attempt to end the grab with the Escape Grab maneuver (see [Common Maneuvers](#) in [Combat](#)).

PRONE

While you are prone, you are lying on the ground and your speed is halved. You take a -1 penalty on melee attacks, melee attacks against you gain a +1 bonus, and ranged attacks against you take a -1 penalty. You can drop prone on your turn in combat (no action required). You can stand up from prone and end the prone condition as a maneuver long as your speed is 1 or higher.

UNCONSCIOUS

While you are unconscious, you are asleep (and when you sleep, you are unconscious). You're prone, your speed is 0, you can't take actions, maneuvers, or reactions, automatically get a doom result on all Agility and Strength tests, and have -4 penalty on Mind tests made to notice anything about your surroundings. Attacks against you always achieve a tier 3 result (though the attacker can roll to see if they get a crit). If you take any damage while unconscious, you wake up and the condition ends. A creature who makes a loud noise, like shouting, wakes up each sleeping creature within 10 squares of them, ending this condition on those creatures.

Usage Dice

Certain equipment, spells, and other effects have a finite number of uses or a duration tracked in usage dice (UD). All UD are d6s. When the rules tell you to roll UD, roll all of the item or effect's dice. If a die rolled is a 1 or 2, that die is removed from the item or effect's UD total. When an effect's UD is 0, it ends. An effect's UD are always rolled at the end of each dungeon turn.

Equipment Usage Dice

If a piece of equipment has usage dice, it is noted as a "UD" entry on its card.

- If the item's UD entry contains "Useless," the item is permanently useless after its UD are 0.
- If an item's UD entry contains "Refuel," then its maximum number of UD are restored when a PC uses the item indicated in the UD entry to restore it. For instance, it takes a pint of oil to restore a lantern's 2 UD.
- If an item's UD entry contains "Rest," then it's maximum number of usage dice are restored when the PC carrying it finish a rest.
- If an item's UD entry contains "Activate," you should roll its usage dice whenever you use the item as specified on its card after resolving any initial effects the item's activation creates.
- If an item's UD entry includes "DT," then you should roll its usage dice at the end of each dungeon turn.

DUNGEON TURNS

Dungeon exploration occurs when the PCs explore a ruin, fortress, cave, or other location room by room. The rules generally refer to these locations as "dungeons."

When the PCs enter a dungeon, the first dungeon turn (DT) begins. Each DT is 30 minutes of real-world time. The Ref should track this time on their phone or some other timer and share the clock with the players. The timer shouldn't be stopped unless the group takes a break from play.

END OF A DUNGEON TURN

At the end of a DT, PCs roll UD for items or effects, and the Ref should roll for an encounter (see [Dungeon Encounters](#)).

GREED BONUS

The Three rewards crows who venture bravely into dungeons and place greed over caution. The deity blesses treasures found quickly, increasing their value. If the PCs find treasure in the first three DTs of entering a dungeon for the first time, the treasure increases in value based on the turn in which it was found.

- 1st DT: 15%
- 2nd DT: 10%
- 3rd DT: 5%

This increase can't apply in that dungeon again to the group (or another group of PCs played by the same players).

Outside the DUNGEON

Sometimes you want to use an item or spell with a duration tracked in UD rolled at the end of a DT outside of a dungeon. Maybe you're traveling through the woods at night carrying a torch, how do you know when it burns out? When not in a dungeon, you can consider every 2 hours of in-fiction time equivalent to a DT.

DUNGEON ENCOUNTERS

The Ref should make an encounter check at the end of each DT and whenever the PCs do something within a dungeon that would attract a lot of attention, like making a lot of noise while breaking down a door with a hammer or setting fire to a huge tapestry and creating smelly smoke.

When the Ref makes an encounter check, they roll 1d6. If the number is equal to or higher than the encounter number (EN), then an encounter occurs (even if the PCs are in the middle of combat). The default EN for a check is 6, but the Ref can lower the number to 5 if a dungeon's level is particularly crowded with creatures (more than twenty as a guideline) or if the PCs have left an inordinate amount of chaos and disorder (such as a trail of bodies) behind them. If both of these conditions are true, decrease the EN to 4.

If an encounter occurs, the Ref should roll on the encounter tables in *The Ref Book* to determine what the PCs encounter. The table chosen should be based on the type of monsters that infest the dungeon. If more than one type of monster is in the dungeon, the Ref chooses a table.

Resting

You can rest to regain your Stamina, lose wounds, and recharge some equipment, like spellbooks. To rest, you must spend at least 6 uninterrupted hours in-game in one place without engaging in strenuous activity, such as exploration or combat, and at least 4 of those hours must be spent sleeping on a bed, bedroll, or similarly comfy surface. While you rest, you must consume at least 1 ration or equivalent food. At the end of a rest, you regain all your Stamina and the number of wounds you have decreases by 1. You choose which wound you lose. Every 2 hours spent resting is one DT.

Rest Encounters

When you rest in a dungeon or out in the wilderness, the Ref should make one encounter check for every 2 hours spent resting to see if encounters occur during a rest. If you rest in a dungeon, the Ref should use Dungeon Encounters. If you rest during overland travel, the Ref should use Travel Encounters. If rest is interrupted by combat or other strenuous activity, the PCs must start resting again to gain the benefits of a rest.

Rest Activities

When you are not sleeping during a rest, you can engage in a light activity (usually done at the same time as being on watch while others sleep). The following rest activities are available to all PCs. Traits and other game rules grant can grant you additional rest activities. You can only perform one rest activity per rest and must complete the rest to gain the benefit of it.

Craft Equipment

You can make one crafting roll to craft an item. See Crafting for more information.

Harvest

You harvest the hide, an organ, or other crafting material from a corpse. See Crafting for more information.

Identify Item

Choose one item you have that is magic. You experiment with the item and learn its properties when you finish the rest.

Prepare for Task

Tell your Ref about a specific task in a specific location that requires a test that you want to prepare for, such as, "I want to prepare to pick the lock on the door in the north hall," or, "I want to prepare to scale the Cliffs of Death." If the task doesn't require or can't be accomplished with a test, the Ref should ask you to choose a new task or rest activity.

The task you choose must be something you have intimate knowledge of. For example, you must have previously interacted with a lock to prepare to pick it or know what makes scaling the Cliffs of Death tricky to prepare to climb them.

When you finish the rest, you gain a +2 bonus on tests made to perform the task. This bonus lasts until you finish another rest.

Repair Armor

You repair a suit of armor or shield you have, restoring its AD to full when you finish the rest. The armor you carry, including the slots it takes up, includes a small kit for making basic repairs.

Tend Wounds

Pick a creature who has at least 2 wounds who rests with you. You can't choose yourself. You spend time tending to that person's wounds. When you and that person finish the rest, they lose 2 wounds instead of 1. A creature can only benefit from this activity once per rest.

Rest Activities in Town

While in a village or other place with no chance of encounters, a PC may wish to perform multiple rest activities per day without having to sleep more than half the day away. A rest activity typically takes about 2 hours of time, and most PCs need time for sleep, meals, socializing, shopping, and other chores while in town. You can accomplish up to 4 rest activities without having to finish a rest per day while in town. Any activities accomplished this way that have effects that kick in when you finish a rest instead kick in after the 2 hours spent working on them, with one exception—the Tend Wounds activity. A creature can only benefit from the Tend Wounds activity once per day, and they only gain the benefit after sleeping for at least 4 hours after the activity is completed.

Light

Without a proper light source, a crow can't effectively navigate their environment, unlike dungeon denizens. There are three levels of light. When an item or effect sheds light, it's listed as X/Y. X is the number of squares it sheds bright light in all directions, and Y is the amount of dimlight it sheds in all directions after that.

Bright Light

Bright light illuminates everything around it clearly. It's sunlight and light that emanates directly from and closest to a source like a torch.

Dim Light

Dim light poorly illuminates an environment, shrouding details in shadow, like moonlight. While attacking a target in dim light or making a test to discern details or search for something or someone, the test has -2 penalty.

Darkness

You take a -4 penalty to attacks and tests made to discern visual details in total darkness. If you are attacking a creature who is moving silently, you must guess which space the target occupies. If you're wrong, your attack automatically misses.

COMMON HAZARDS

While all manner of hazards await the crows, these are some of the most common.

Falling

When you fall 10 feet or more, you take 1d6 P damage per 10 feet fallen. You can use your reaction to make an RR to reduce the damage.

2d10 + A (RR)

(≤11) No effect.

(12-16) The damage is reduced by 1d6.

(17+) The damage is reduced by 2d6.

Starvation

Each day a you go without eating at least 1 ration worth of food, you gain a starvation wound. A starvation wound functions like a normal wound, except that you remove all starvation wounds when you eat 1 ration or equivalent food.

Suffocation

If you can't breathe, the Ref tracks your time and movement tracked as if you're in combat. You can hold your breath for a number of combat rounds equal to 3 + your Strength score. At the start of each round after this that you can't breathe, you take 1d6 damage.

Line of Effect

To target a creature or object with an attack, spell, or other effect, you must have line of effect to that target. If any solid object, such as a wall or pillar, completely blocks the target from you, then you don't have line of effect.

If you're not sure whether you have line of effect to a target, imagine drawing a straight line from any corner of the space you occupy on an encounter map to any corner of a space the target occupies (see [Size and Space](#)). If one or more corners of your space connect to any corner of the target's space with no obstruction in between, you have line of effect to the target.

At the Ref's discretion, flimsy or fragile obstructions such as a glass window or linen curtains don't block line of effect, and might be automatically broken or torn by attacks, spells, or other effects used through them.

If you create an environmental effect, such as a portal, you must have line of effect to the space where you create the environmental effect.

Cover

When you have line of effect to a creature or object but that target has at least half their form blocked by a solid object such as a tree, wall, or overturned table, the target has cover. You take a -2 penalty on attacks made against them.

Concealment

Fog, rain, and other obscurements that don't protect a creature's physical form are treated like dim light (for light fog, rain, and other effects) or darkness (for heavy fog, rain, and other effects).

Invisibility

If you are invisible, you are treated as if you are in darkness.

Combat

Most crows don't seek out fights, but when you're cornered by unded in a dungeon or find a horde of blood monsters between you and a pile of gold, it's time to draw steel. Approach combat with caution. Death is always an option.

Combat happens in rounds. During each round of combat, each combatant gets a turn to act. The round ends after all combatants have had a turn and a new one begins until all the combatants left decide or are forced to stop fighting.

Grid and Distance

Combat uses miniatures and a grid. Distances are measured in squares on the grid. For ease of play (and defying Pythagoras), diagonal distances are measured the same as non-diagonal distances.

Scale

Each square on the grid measures 5 feet across.

Size and Space

Each creature has a size that describes how many squares they occupy on a grid as shown on the Creature Size table. The number of squares a creature takes up are referred to as their space.

You can't occupy the space of another creature. You can move through the space of other creatures provided you don't stop in those spaces. Spaces occupied by enemies are difficult terrain (see [Difficult Terrain](#)).

Squeezing

At the Ref's discretion, a creature can squeeze themselves into a space smaller than what they normally occupy. While squeezed, their speed is halved and attacks against them gain a +1 bonus.

Reach

Your reach is determined by your size as shown on the Creature Sizes table. Your reach determines the distance in squares you can be away from a creature or object and still target it with melee attacks and other effects that specify using your reach. Humans are Medium sized and have a reach of 1. Some weapons extend your reach when you make attacks or counters with those weapons (and only when making attacks and counters with those weapons).

Creature Sizes

Size	Squares	Reach
Tiny	1	1
Small	1	1
Medium	1	1
Large	2 × 2	2
Huge	3 × 3	2
Holy Shit!	4 × 4*	3

*At the Ref's discretion, Holy Shit! creatures can be even bigger.

Surprised

If combat begins with one or more creatures unaware of the others, those creatures are surprised. Surprised creatures can't take a turn and attacks against them gain a +1 bonus. After the first round of combat, surprised creatures are no longer surprised.

Who Goes First?

At the start of each round of combat, a player of the Ref's choice should roll 1d10. If the result is a 6 or higher, the PCs and any NPC allies they have can take their turn followed by their enemies, and vice versa if the result is 5 or lower. Players determine the order in which the PCs and their allies take turns, and the Ref determines the order of their enemies. This roll is repeated at the start of each round.

Turn

On your turn, you can take a maneuver and an action or use two maneuvers. You can also choose to only take one action or one maneuver or do nothing. You can't break up your turn with another creature's turn.

Most actions you can take are determined by their equipment and traits. The most common action is to make an attack with a weapon or a spell (see [Making Attacks](#)).

COMMON MANEUVERS

The following maneuvers are available to all creatures. Some equipment or traits give you access to other maneuvers.

- **Move Speed:** You move a number of squares up to your speed. You can break up this maneuver with your action or another maneuver.
- **Shift:** Move 1 square without provoking opportunity attacks (see [Opportunity Attacks](#)).
- **Command:** You command a pet you control to use an action or maneuver. See [Pets in Combat](#).
- **Draw From Pack:** You attempt to draw an item from your backpack (see [Swapping Slots](#)).
- **Draw From Belt:** You draw an item or two from your belt (see [Swapping Slots](#)).
- **Pick Up Item:** You pick up an unattended item within your reach, provided you have enough hand slots free to grab it.
- **Stand Up:** You must be prone and have a speed of at least 1 to use this maneuver. You stand up.
- **Grab:** You can make the following test, targeting one creature of your size or smaller within your reach. You can only grab one creature this way at a time.

2d10 + S + Unarmed skill

- The target can counter.
 - The target is grabbed by you, and the target can counter.
 - The target is grabbed by you.
- **Escape Grab:** If you are grabbed, you can make the following test to wrestle your way out of the grasp of your grabber.

2d10 + A or S + Unarmed skill

- The grabber can counter.
 - You are no longer grabbed, and the grabber can counter.
 - You are no longer grabbed and can move 1 square without provoking opportunity attacks.
- **Knockback:** You can make the following test, targeting one creature within your reach.

2d10 + S + Unarmed skill

- The target can counter.
- Push 1
- Push 2

Ready an Action

You can use your action to ready a specific action or maneuver that activates when a trigger you name is met. You might say, "I'm going to use my sword to attack the next enemy who moves within 1 square of me," or, "I'm going to cast the *minor healing* spell on Boris next time he takes damage." When the trigger you specified occurs, you can use your reaction to execute the action or maneuver. If the trigger hasn't occurred by your next turn, you must ready the action or maneuver again to be able to use a reaction to execute it. See [Reactions](#) for more information.

Boring Stuff

Boring stuff, like opening an unlocked door or knocking an arrow, requires no maneuver or action unless the Ref deems otherwise.

Making Shit Up

If you want to do something impactful that isn't specified in the rules, tell the Ref. Your Ref decides if the task requires a maneuver or an action and what, if any, test needs to be made.

Making Attacks

There are two kinds of attacks: melee attacks and ranged attacks, which can be made with either weapons or spells. When you make an attack, it must be made with a weapon or spellbook you are wielding. That equipment tells you if the attack is melee or ranged, what sort of test is required, and how much damage it deals at each tier to its target.

When you make an attack with a weapon (also called a weapon attack), you can apply the appropriate weapon skill to the test. When you make an attack with a spell (also called a spell attack), you can add the appropriate magic skill to the test.

When you get a tier 1 result on an attack, you deal no damage or other effects to your target, and there's another potential consequence depending on if the attack was melee or ranged. A tier 1 result on an attack is called a miss. A tier 2 or 3 result on an attack is called a hit.

Thrown weapons, like daggers, allow you to make a melee or ranged attack. When you make an attack with this weapon, you decide before you make the test if it is melee or ranged.

Melee Attacks

To make a melee attack against a creature or object, they must be within reach of the weapon or spell you wield. If you miss, the target of the attack can counter (see [Counter](#)).

All creatures can make an unarmed strike as the following melee attack. Unarmed strikes include punching, kicking, headbutting, and the like and attacks made with objects that aren't normally used as weapons (such as torches or chair legs).

2d10 + A or S + Unarmed skill

 The target can counter.

 1 + A or S dam

 2 + A or S dam

Ranged Attacks

To make a ranged attack against a creature or object, they must be within a number of squares equal to the range of the weapon or spell you wield. A ranged weapon attack can go further, and takes a -2 penalty for every 1 square the target is beyond normal range. Weapons with only a melee range are technically ranged 0.

When you get a miss on a ranged attack, any ammunition fired in the attack is destroyed. If the target was adjacent to one or more allies, your attack instead hits one of those allies chosen randomly by the Ref. You deal the tier 2 result of the weapon you made the attack with to that ally. If your rolled a doom on your attack, you instead deal the tier 3 result to your ally.

If you make a ranged attack against an adjacent creature, the attack takes a -1 penalty.

Crits ON Attacks

When you get a crit on an attack, you get an another action that you must use immediately if this action is gained on a turn other than yours. If this action is gained on your turn, you can use it at any time during the turn it was gained.

Multiple Targets

Unless noted otherwise, an attack targets one creature or object within its reach or range. If an attack can target more than one creature or object, you choose which creatures to target within your reach or range and make one attack that applies to all targets. You can't target the same creature more than once with an attack.

Flanking

When you and one or more allies are adjacent to the same enemy and on opposite sides of the enemy, you are flanking that enemy. While flanking an enemy, you gain +1 bonus on melee attacks against them.

You can't flank an enemy if you or the ally you're flanking with are boned, prone, grabbed, or grabbing a creature who isn't the target.

If you're unsure whether you and an ally are flanking a foe, imagine a line extending from the center of your space to the center of your ally's space. If that line passes through opposite sides or corners of the enemy's space, then you and your ally are flanking the enemy.

High Ground

If you are at least 1 square above a target, you gain a +1 bonus on attacks against them.

Reactions

Every round, each creature has 1 reaction they can use at any point on their turn or another creature's turn. Each reaction has a trigger and can only occur when that trigger happens. A reaction always happens after the triggering event resolves. There are two common reactions, counters and opportunity attacks, available to all creatures. Some equipment or traits give a creature access to other reactions.

Counter

When a creature or object within reach of a melee weapon you are currently wielding makes a melee attack against you, uses the Grab or Knockback maneuver while targeting you, or attempts to escape being grabbed by you with the Escape Grab maneuver and gets a tier 1 result, you can use your reaction to counter. If you do, you deal the tier 2 result of the weapon you're wielding to the triggering creature or object. If the triggering test result was doom, you deal the tier 3 result instead.

Opportunity Attack

When a creature moves out of your reach (unmodified by a weapon), you can use a reaction to make an attack with a weapon you are wielding against them before they leave your reach. This is called an opportunity attack.

Movement

The distance you move in a single maneuver or action can't be greater than your speed. Most of the time when a creature is moving in combat, they can use the Move Speed maneuver to move a number of squares up to a number of squares equal to their speed. Easy stuff.

Difficult Terrain

Brambles, rubble, and other obstacles are difficult terrain, which is hard to move through. Entering a square of difficult terrain costs an extra square of movement. You can't jump out of difficult terrain or use the Shift maneuver to enter or while within difficult terrain.

Swimming and Climbing

Entering a square that requires you to swim, such as a lake or an ocean, or climb, such as moving up a cliff or castle wall, costs an extra square of movement. At the Ref's discretion, you might also have to make a test to see if it's even possible for you to swim or climb. If a creature has a swimming or climbing speed, then they can swim and climb at that speed without spending extra movement or needing to make a test, including climbing upside down on ceilings. If you are fully submerged in liquid and don't have a swimming speed, you take a -1 penalty on Agility and Strength tests.

Flying

If a creature has a flying speed, then they can move vertically and remain the air. If a creature who is flying is knocked prone or their speed is reduced to 0, they fall.

Jumping

Whenever you move, you can jump as part of that movement. The total distance you move, including jumping, can't exceed your speed. You make the following test when you jump.

2d10 + A or S + Jump skill

≤11 You jump 0 squares.

12-16 You jump up to a distance of 2 squares with a height of 1 square.

17+ You can jump up to a distance equal to 2 + your Agility or Strength (minimum total distance 3 squares) with a height of 1 square.

Teleporting

When you teleport, you move from one space to another instantaneously, bypassing obstacles.

- Teleporting doesn't provoke opportunity attacks or other effects triggered by moving.
- When you teleport yourself, you must have line of effect to your destination space. When you teleport another creature, you must have line of effect from the space the teleported creature leaves and to their destination space.
- A teleporting creature's destination space can't be occupied by another creature or object.
- The effect that lets a creature teleport indicates how far they can teleport. That distance can be greater than the creature's speed.
- If you teleport while prone, you remain prone.
- If you teleport while grabbed, the condition ends for you. If you teleport while grabbing another creature, the condition ends for them.

Pets in Combat

In combat and other situations tracked in combat rounds, you could have one or more pets you own, such as a horse you ride or a goat who follows you around. These pets don't take turns of their own, but you can use the Command maneuver to have a pet you own use a maneuver and an action or two maneuvers they can perform. The Ref has final say in what maneuvers or actions an animal can or can't take.

If you want a pet you own to do something complex or particularly dangerous, walk a complicated path or leap over a bonfire, the Ref can ask you to make the following test:

2d10 + M + Handle Animal skill

≤11 The pet refuses the command.

12-16 The pet follows the command but is boned after doing so.

17+ The pet follows the command.

Commanding a pet to attack a dangerous creature typically doesn't trigger this test, since most animals raised or purchased by crows have been trained to face monsters.

You can ride a pet you own as long as it is at least one size greater than you.

FORCED MOVEMENT

Some weapons, spells, and other effects allow you to forcibly move a creature or object. There are two types of forced movement.

[Hold for edits and diagrams of flanking/forced movement or cards]

- **Push X:** The creature moves the target up to X squares away from them in a straight line, without moving them vertically. Each square the creature moves the target must put the target further away from them.
- **Slide X:** The creature moves the target up to X squares in any direction, except for vertically. A slide doesn't need to be a straight line.

When you force move a target, you can move them fewer squares than the number indicated. Forced movement ignores difficult terrain and never provokes opportunity attacks or other reactions or effects that involve a creature moving unless specified. There is one exception. When you force move a target into damaging terrain or into terrain that produces an effect, including a temporary magic effect, they are affected as if they had moved into it willingly.

A creature can't be force moved into a space occupied by another creature or an object. You can't use a mundane weapon or effect to force move a creature larger than you. Magical forced movement effects work on all creatures.

Vertical

If a forced movement effect has the word "vertical" in front of it, then the forced movement can move a target up or down in addition to horizontally. If a creature who can't fly is left in midair at the end of a vertical forced move, they fall. Forced movement made against a creature who is flying is always a vertical forced move, whether or not the effect specifies it.

Non-vertical forced movement can move a target along a physical slope such as a hill or staircase. For a target to be force moved along a slope, each square of the slope can be no more than 1 square higher or lower than the previous square.

Into a Fall

If you can't fly and are force moved across an open space that would cause you to fall, you continue moving the total distance you were moved first. If you are still in a position to fall when the forced movement ends, you fall.

Overland Travel

Overland travel occurs when the PCs move from one location to another across vast swaths of land or explore to discover points of interest.

If weather conditions are pleasant and you travel over fairly level, unpaved terrain, you can travel at a base pace of 12 miles a day, which is about 8 hours of travel (not including breaks for water, meals, etc). After this, you must rest if you wish to continue further without taking damage.

If you want to travel further than normal in a day, you can push yourself. To move an extra distance equal to half your base pace, which takes another 4 hours of travel time, you must make the following test.

2d10 + S + Endurance skill

- ≤11 You take 3d6 P dam.
- 12-16 You take 2d6 P dam.
- 17+ You take 1d6 P dam.

A creature can make this test multiple times in a row without resting to keep pushing to move further, with a cumulative -2 penalty for each test to push repeated after the first.

Mounts and vehicles can change the base speed at which you move overland (see the *Player's Guide*). A group moves as fast as their slowest member.

Hex Maps

One of the best ways to track the group's overland travel progress is by using a regional map that uses hexes for measurement. If each hex is 6 (or 2 or 3) miles across, you just need to keep track of which hexes the PCs are traveling through. You can also reveal what type of terrain and points of interest are inside each hex when the PCs enter it for the first time.

Travel Procedure

Each day that the group travels, the Ref should resolve overland travel in the following order.

1. Determine the route's terrain type.
2. Determine the day's weather. PCs make any tests associated with it.
3. Each PC declares a travel role and makes a test related to the role.
4. Each human makes a test to resist the Miasma.
5. Run any point of interest scenes and roll for random encounters and resolve any that occur.
6. If the group decides to push to travel further, each should make a test to push. Resolve any random encounters and point of interest scenes that occur during these new travel stretches.
7. When the group rests, follow the procedure for resting and repeat the travel procedure for subsequent days of travel.

Terrain

The type of terrain you travel on changes your base pace.

- **Normal:** Normal terrain moves over natural ground without a lot of impediments, such as light forests and grasslands.
- **Road:** Traveling on a paved road or well trod path doubles your base pace.
- **Rough:** Rough terrain, such as dense underbrush, mountains, and glaciers, halves your base pace.

Weather

At the start of each new day traveling, the Ref should check for the weather by rolling on one of the appropriate weather tables below based on the climate or season in which the PCs travel.

Cold of Winter Climate

1d6	Weather
1	Blizzard
2-5	Cold
6	Snow

Desert Climate

1d6	Weather
1-4	Heat wave (day) and cold (night)
5	Sandstorm
6	Thunderstorm

Fall Climate

1d6	Weather
1	Fog
2-5	Pleasant
6	Rain

Spring Climate

1d6	Weather
1-4	Pleasant
5	Rain
6	Thunderstorm

Summer or Tropical Climate

1d6	Weather
1	Heat wave
2-4	Pleasant
5	Rain
6	Thunderstorm

Blizzard

During a blizzard, you divide your base pace by 3. At the end of each hour you spend outside without cold weather gear, make the following test.

2d10 + S + Endurance skill

<=11 You take 5d6 P dam.

12-16 You take 4d6 P dam.

17+ You take 3d6 P dam.

You take a -2 penalty to this test for each time you've test previously made this test before donning cold weather gear or seeking shelter or experiencing a change in the weather.

Guides, scouts, and foragers take a -4 penalty on tests made to fulfill their roles.

Cold

During cold weather, at the end of each hour you spend outside without cold weather gear, make the following test.

2d10 + S + Endurance skill

<=11 You take 3d6 P dam.

12-16 You take 2d6 P dam.

17+ You take 1d6 P dam.

You take a -1 penalty to this test for each time you've test previously made this test before donning cold weather gear or seeking shelter or experiencing a change in the climate.

Fog

While in fog, guides, scouts, and foragers take a -2 penalty on tests made to fulfill their roles.

Heat Wave

During a heat wave, you can travel at half your base pace without any fear of damage from the weather. If you travel at a faster pace, you must make the following test.

2d10 + S + Endurance

<=11 You take 2d6 P dam.

12-16 You take 1d6 P dam.

17+ You take no dam.

All Strength tests made to push to travel further take a -2 penalty during a heat wave.

Pleasant

Pleasant weather has no effect on travel.

Rain

In the rain, your base pace is halved. If you are carrying rations, you must make the following test to secure your food.

2d10 + M + Nature Lore skill

<=11 You lose 1d6 + 1 rations to mold.

12-16 You lose 1 ration to mold.

17+ You lose no rations to mold.

Guides, scouts, and foragers take a -2 penalty on tests made to fulfill their roles.

Sandstorm

During a sandstorm, divide your base pace by 3, and guides, scouts, and gatherers take a -4 penalty on tests made to fulfill their roles.

Snow

In snow, your base pace is halved. and guides, scouts, and foragers take a -2 penalty on tests made to fulfill their roles. Snow also has the effects of cold weather.

Thunderstorm

In a thunderstorm, your base pace is divided by 3. If you are carrying rations, you must make the following test to secure your food.

2d10 + M + Nature Lore skill

- ≤11 You lose 2d6 rations to mold.
- 12-16 You lose 1d6 ration to mold.
- 17+ You lose no rations no rations.

Guides, scouts, and gatherers take a -4 penalty on tests made to fulfill their roles.

Travel Roles

Each day you travel, assign a PC to the guide role. You can assign one PC to the scout role and any number of PCs to the forager and leader roles. Each role has a test that to make at the start of each day spent traveling. For each doom result, an encounter occurs that day (see [Travel Encounters](#)).

Forager

Foragers hunt for game and edible vegetation while traveling. They make the following test. While in a desert climate or other habitat that's short on food sources, this test takes a -2 penalty.

2d10 + A or S

- ≤11 The forager finds no food.
- 12-16 The forager procures 1 ration.
- 17+ The forager procures 3 rations.

Guide

The guide leads the group through the wilderness to their destination. They make the following test if they traveled the route before or if they follow a map or road.

2d10 + M + Navigate skill

- ≤11 The group moves at their normal pace toward the destination.
- 12-16 The group moves at their normal pace, and the route gives the scout and any foragers a +2 bonus on tests related to their role today.
- 17+ As tier 2, and the group moves faster than normal and can travel up to 50% further during the initial travel portion of their journey without a test to push.

If the guide hasn't traveled the route before and has no map or road to their destination, they make the following test instead.

2d10 + M + Navigate skill

- ≤11 The group gets lost (see [Lost](#)).
- 12-16 The group moves at their normal pace toward the destination.
- 17+ The group moves at their normal pace, and the route gives the scout and any foragers a +2 bonus on tests related to their role today.

Leader

Leaders maintain the group's morale against the Miasma by getting them to share stories, play games, and the like. Each leader in the group can make the following test.

2d10 + M

- ≤11 The leader provides no bonus to their allies.
- 12-16 The leader's allies gain a +1 bonus to tests made to resist the effects of the Miasma.
- 17+ As tier 2, except the bonus is +2.

Scout

The scout moves ahead of the group and looks for signs of oncoming danger. They make the following test.

2d10 + A or M

- ≤11 The day's EN decreases by 2.
- 12-16 The day's EN decreases by 1.
- 17+ The day's EN remains the same.

Base Pace Changes Stack

Changes to your base pace created by a mount, terrain, and weather take effect at the same time. If you're riding a horse in the rain down a road, the horse makes your base pace 18 miles a day. The road doubles that pace to 26 miles a day, but the rain halves it to bring it back down to 18.

Lost

If the group gets lost during travel, the Ref has two different methods of determining where the crows end up. While lost, a group doesn't know their exact position in the world.

Hex Map Lost

If the Ref uses a hex map, they roll 1d6 each time the group would leave a hex during the travel day and keeps the result a secret. Starting with the hex the PCs want to enter, count a number of adjacent hexes to the one they leave equal to the result going in a clockwise direction. The number rolled is the hex the PCs actually enter. If the result is a 1, the PCs move in the direction they want to move. If it is a 2, they move one hex clockwise from the direction they want to move.

No Hex Map Lost

If you're not using a hex map to track travel, instead roll on the Lost Direction table to determine the direction the group that day.

Lost Direction

d10	Direction Traveled
1	North
2	Northeast
3	East
4	Southeast
5	South
6	Southwest
7	West
8	Northwest
9	Roll twice, ignoring this result if it's rolled again. The group moves the first direction for half of their journey and the other direction for the second half.
10	No progress (travel in circles)

Back on Track

At the start of a travel day when lost, the guide makes the following test to instead of the normal test they make to travel.

2d10 + M + Navigate skill

(≤11) The group remains lost.

(12-16) The group isn't lost anymore and can move at a normal pace toward their destination.

(17+) As tier 2, but the guide's route gives the scout and any foragers a +2 bonus on tests related to their role today.

The group can also get back on track by finding a map, stumbling into a place they recognize that would allow them to get their bearings, or having an NPC provide directions.

Miasma

Outdoor areas in Cornath are affected by a nearly invisible, magic haze called the Miasma. It's the result of the spells used during the Necromancer War. The Miasma lingers outside, but can't enter indoor areas. This phenomenon corrupts the souls of humans, making them commit selfish and wicked acts. Too much time in the Miasma can create a permanent change. While a human is boned, they can't lose any levels of the condition while within the Miasma. Every 24 hours a human spends within the Miasma, they must make the following test.

2d10 + M + Endurance skill

(≤11) The human is boned and must roll for a Miasma effect on the Miasma Effects table.

(12-16) The human is boned.

(17+) No effect.

When you roll on the Miasma Effects table, you roll 1d10 + your current boned level. If the result is an effect that is already affecting you, then roll again for a different result.

Changes in Terrain and Climate

You could have a travel day where you pass through multiple kinds of terrain or climates. The Ref can figure out in which terrain and climate the PCs spend most of their time that day and use that terrain and climate to calculate base pace and figure out the weather.

Miasma Effects

d10 + boned	Effect
1-2	You become despondent. You only speak if spoken to first and give one-word responses until you exit the Miasma.
3-4	You becomes ravenous and greedy. You must eat at least 2 rations during a rest to get the benefits of a rest until you are out of the Miasma.
5-6	You enter a destructive rage and destroy one mundane item randomly chosen by the Ref from your backpack.
7-8	You become decietful. You can only communicate in lies until you are out of the Miasma.
9-10	Your become lazy. You refuse to have any travel role until you are out of the Miasma.
11-12	You relish violence. In combat, you must keep pursing and fighting your foes until you can no longer sense them. This effect ends when you are no longer boned.
13+	All of your other Miasma effects end and all your levels of boned disappear. You can't suffer any new Miasma effects and are permanently selfish and cruel. You become become an NPC controlled by the Ref.

Encounters and POIs

During overland travel, the Ref can describe the journey in a couple sentences as a simple montage. “You travel through the forest to reach your destination on a pleasant day. During the first few hours of your journey, the guide knows the way, the scout reports no trouble ahead, but the foragers find no food or game either.”

There are two instances the Ref should zoom in on the action. One is random encounters that occur during overland travel. The other is when points of interest (POIs), like unique landmarks, dungeons, and obstacles both mundane and magic, lie in the PCs' path.

Travel Encounters

Travel encounters are run-ins the PCs have with monsters, bandits, magic phenonon, or other travelers on the road. The Ref should roll an encounter check each time the PCs travel a distance equal to half their pace for the day and each time they investigate a POI.

Travel encounter checks follow the same rules as the checks for dungeon encounters (see [Dungeon Encounters](#)). The default EN is 6. Decrease the number to 5 if the check occurs in a place that contains more monsters, such as a dense forest surrounding a ruined, undead-filled castle with crumbling walls. Decrease the number to 4 if the PCs travel through a place overrun with monsters, such as a ruined city that contains multiple dungeons.

If an encounter occurs, the Ref should roll on the encounter tables in *The Ref Book* to determine what the PCs encounter. The table chosen should be based on the monsters that infest the dungeon closest to the PCs. If two or more dungeons are equally close to the PCs, the Ref chooses a table at random.

POIs

POIs are landmarks significant enough for the Ref to zoom in on the travel and play out an exploration scene. At the Ref's discretion, these scenes can be run using DTs.

A POI should be an obstacle the PCs have to overcome to continue on their intended path or a landmark they might wish to visit or investigate futher. If the PCs decide to divert their path to avoid the obstacle or to not investigate the POI, it may be a short diversion away from the rest of the overland travel proceduce, and that's fine!

If the PCs have an obstacle before them and attempt to overcome it, the specifics of overcoming that obstacle are up tot he Ref. *The Ref Book* has examples obstacles. The details of landmarks, such as dungeons or settlements, are determined by the Ref.

Spellcasting

The Archmages fused their spells into the pages of books so academic and religious scholars could harness the magic to benefit Cornath. Though these sages were the best folks suited to the task, anyone who held one of the books could attempt to cast its spell. The more powerful the spell, the fewer times it was copied into a tome to prevent abuse and mishaps.

Spellbooks

The spell contained in the pages of a book has the following statistics.

Rank

A spell's rank form 0 to 5 that indicates its power. A higher rank means a more powerful spell.

Discipline

A spell's discipline describes the type of magic it harnesses and the spellcasting skill used for the test made to cast the spell.

- **Alteration:** Physically changes matter
- **Benefaction:** Heals and buffs creatures
- **Conjuration:** Teleports and summons creatures and objects
- **Elemental:** Harnesses the power of the air, earth, fire, and water
- **Illusion:** Creates effects that fool the senses
- **Necromancy:** Creates curses, poison, disease, and monsters

Casting Time

A spell's casting time indicates how long it takes to cast.

- **Action:** You must use an action to cast the spell.
- **Maneuver:** You must use a maneuver to cast the spell.
- **Reaction:** The spell must be cast as a reaction in response to a trigger, which will be listed in its description.
- **Out of Combat:** This complex spell can't be cast in situations tracked in combat rounds. It can be cast outside of such situations and takes 10 minutes of in-game time to cast.

Target

A spell's target indicate how many and which creatures or objects it affects.

- **Number:** The first word in a target entry is a numebr, typically 1, 2, or 3. This indicates the number of creatures or objects you can target with this spell. If the number is greater than 1, you can choose to target fewer creatures or objects than that number, but you can't target the same creature more than once with a single casting of a spell. If instead of a number, it says, "All" then all of the specified targets within the spell's range or area of effect (see [Area of Effect](#)) are targeted. You can't disclude valid targets when "all" are targeted.
- **Allies:** This spell targets creatures friendly to you, including yourself.
- **Enemy:** The spell targets creatures hostile to you. The Ref has final say in which creatures are hostile or friendly toward you.
- **Creature:** This spell can target any creatures other than you.
- **Object:** This spell can target any object not carried or worn by another creature.
- **Summoned:** This spell summons a creature or object within range. You can summon the target into any unoccupied space within range. If the the summoned target is an object and you have enough hand or belt slots free to hold the object, you can summon the object into those slots.
- **Target:** If a spell lists its target as "target(s)," then it can target any creature other than you or object not carried or worn by another creature. If you can target more than 1 "target," you can mix and match creatures and objects.
- **No Target Entry:** Some spells don't have a target entry. If the spell is an attack, that's because it can attack any creature or object. If the spell isn't an attack, they its description should indicate how it works without a target.

Range

A spell's range indicates the maximum number of squares you can be from a target in order to target them with the spell. The target must also be within your line of effect.

Area of Effect

Some spells target an area of effect. Instead of individual creatures or objects, they target all creatures or objects within a specific area.

If a spell originates a distance away from you, then 1 square of the area of effect must be within that distance, and must also be within your line of effect. This square is referred to as the origin square of the area of effect. The area of effect can spread from the origin square however you choose, according to the rules for the shape and arrangement of that particular area.

You can place an area of effect to include one or more squares where you don't have line of effect, as long as you have line of effect to the origin square. Unless otherwise noted, spells don't pass through solid barriers such as walls or ceilings, and they don't spread around corners.

An spell might use any of the following areas of effect.

- **Aura X:** The number X is the radius of the aura in squares, which always originates from you and moves with you for the duration of the ability that created it.
- **Cube X:** When an spell affects a cubic area, the number X is the length of each of the area's sides in squares.
- **Line A × B:** The number A denotes the line's length in squares, while the number B equals the line's width and height in squares. When you create a line area of effect, the squares in that area must be in a straight line.

Duration

A spell's duration indicates how long any lingering effects it creates last. If a spell's caster dies, the spell ends. A caster can end a spell early (no action required).

- **Instant:** The spell exists only in the instant it is cast. The magic can put a lasting condition on a creature that has a specified duration elsewhere in the rules (such as blessed or boned).
- **DT:** The spell lasts until the end of the DT in which it is cast.
- **UD:** The spell is maintained through a specified number of UD, which are rolled at the end of each DT.

Spellbook Usage Dice

Each spellbook has 1 or more UD, which are rolled whenever its spell is cast. When the spellbook's UD are 0, it has no magic and the spell can't be cast from its book until its usage dice are restored. A spellbook you carry regains all its UD when you finish a rest.

When you get a crit on a casting, you don't need to roll the spell's UD.

Casting

Each time you cast a spell from a spellbook, you must make a Mind test and add the applicable spellcasting skill. The outcomes for each casting are listed in the spell's description.

Magic Backlashes

The chaotic, sentient force of magic doesn't like to be manipulated, and lashes out against those who seek to control it when their grasp of a spell is weak. A backlash happens when magic pushes back against the caster, intent on harming them.

When a backlash occurs, the Ref rolls a d100 + the rank of the triggering spell on the Backlashes table to determine the event that takes place. Backlashes occur instead of the spell that was meant to trigger them, but the caster still needs to roll the spellbook's UD.

If a backlash effect requires the spell have a target that is a creature, and the target of the spell is an object, the spellcaster becomes the target for purposes of the backlash effect. If the caster is suffering from a backlash with a duration (aside from being boned), and gets that same backlash again, the Ref should roll for a different backlash unless the backlash's effects stack. UD for backlash effects are rolled at the end of each DT.

There are two ways a backlash occurs. If a creature gets doom on a casting, a backlash occurs. The second way uses the Chaos Count.

Chaos Count

The Chaos Count (CC) is a secret number the Ref maintains during play and starts at 0. Each time a creature makes a casting from a spellbook and gets a tier 1 result that isn't a doom, the Ref rolls 1d6 + the spell's rank and adds the result to the CC. When a casting causes the CC to be 13 or higher, a backlash occurs and the CC resets to 0.

Backlashes

d100 + Rank	Backlash
01-02	Your head transforms into a donkey's head. You can't speak, only bray at a loud volume. This effect has 1 UD.
03-04	Your magic makes you feel so good that you are compelled to dance at all times. While under this effect, your speed is reduced by 2 and you have a -2 penalty to tests made to climb, hide, sneak, or swim. This effect has 1 UD.
05-06	You summon a ghostly, self-playing accordion that can't be destroyed and follows you wherever you go and plays polka loudly until the end of this DT. It is impossible to go anywhere without notice as this accordion plays.
07-08	Each time you speak between now and the end of this DT, roll a d10. On a 10, your words unleash a thunderous boom. Each creature within 3 squares of you takes 1d6 damage. If you are already suffering this backlash, the damage increases by 1d6.
09-10	Your mood becomes fiery and irritable. If you don't harm another creature before the end of this DT, then the fire inside you makes you take 1d6 P damage. If you are already suffering this backlash, the damage increases by 1d6.
11-12	Your body temperature drops, making you very cold until the end of this DT. During this time, your speed is reduced by 1 and if you start your turn submerged in water or soaked with water, you take 1d6 P damage. If you are already suffering this backlash, then your speed is further reduced by 1.
13-14	Magic lightly muddles your mind. You are boned.
15-16	Magic greatly muddles your mind. You are twice boned.

d100 + Rank	Backlash
17-18	Your body becomes seasoned by magic, making your bones and psyche brittle. The next time you take damage before the end of the DT, you take twice as much as you normally would.
19-20	A limb you use to hold items goes numb and can't be moved. The Ref picks one of your hand slots. You drop any item in that slot and you can't use the hand slot until the end of the DT.
21-22	Hungry magic erupts from your body and destroys the nearest 1d6 rations.
23-24	Your magic creates a thunderous boom that can be heard by all creatures within 100 squares of you. The curious ones come to investigate.
25-26	A powerful gust of wind pushes you and every creature within 10 squares of you 1d6 squares in a random direction determined by the Ref.
27-28	You infuse negative energy into yourself and take 1d6 damage.
29-30	You teleport 1d6 squares in a direction chosen by the Ref into an unoccupied space.
31-32	Shuffle your inventory cards into a deck. Roll a d10. Then pull a number of cards equal to the result from the top of the deck. The last card pulled is a piece of equipment that turns into a goat under the Ref's control. The equipment remains a goat until the goat dies, at which point it transforms back into the original equipment.

d100 + Rank	Backlash
33-34	Shuffle your inventory cards into a deck. Roll a d10. Then pull a number of cards equal to the result from the top of the deck. The last card pulled is a piece of equipment that is teleported into the possession of another creature randomly chosen by the Ref within 20 squares of you.
35-36	Shuffle your inventory cards into a deck. Roll a d10. Then pull a number of cards equal to the result from the top of the deck. The last card pulled is a piece of equipment that transforms into a feather duster until the end of this DT.
37-38	A sticky goo falls from the sky onto your body. Until this goo disappears at the end of this DT, your speed is reduced by 2. If you are already suffering from the effect of this backlash, your speed is reduced an additional 2.
39-40	A noxious, unpleasant-smelling cloud of gas forms around your head and follows you wherever you go. This gas imposes a -1 penalty on all power roll. This effect has 1 UD. If you already have a cloud of gas, its effects get stronger, and the penalty decreases by -1.
41-42	You open a channel into the target of the spell's mind and their worst fears are shared with your allies within 10 squares of them. Each ally takes 1d6 P damage.
43-44	You are compelled to speak only in rhyming couplets. If you fail to do so, you take 1d6 P damage. This effect has 1UD.
45-46	Your body becomes porcelain. While in this form, whenever you take non-piercing damage, you take twice as much. This effect has 1 UD.

d100 + Rank	Backlash
47-48	You are outlined in a supernatural light which makes it impossible for you to hide and easy to attack. Attacks against you gain +2 while this light is active. This effect has 1 UD.
49-50	Fire erupts from your body. You and each creature within 2 squares of you takes 1d6 damage.
51-52	You summon open a portal that unleashes a horde of demonic bees that flit through the local area and then fly back through the portal before it closes. You and each creature within 3 squares of you must make a Might RR. ≤11 6 damage; boned 12-16 3 damage 17+ No effect
53-54	Tentacles erupt from your body. You and each creature within 3 squares of you takes 1d6 damage. The tentacles become nonfunctional immediately after emerging and you gain three special wounds. You or a creature who can reach you can remove a special wound's worth of tentacles from your body with a bladed tool or weapon as an action without doing further harm to you. Once all these wounds are removed, so are all the tentacles.
55-56	You summon a load of dirt that falls from the sky, smashing down on you and each creature within 2 squares of you. Each affected creature must make an Agility RR. ≤11 6 damage; prone 12-16 3 damage 17+ No effect
57-58	Your magic summons 1d6 blood A creatures who appear in unoccupied spaces within 5 squares of you. These creatures are hostile to you.

d100 + Rank	Backlash
59-60	You are so overwhelmed with emotion that you fall prone and can't stand up, crawling wherever you wish to go. This effect has 1 UD.
61-62	Your hands become feet until the end of the DT. You gain +2 speed, but you can't hold or manipulate any objects with your hands while this effect lasts.
62-64	The ground beneath you and within 1 square of you turns to quicksand. Each creature standing on the ground must make an Agility RR. ≤11 The creature is grappled by the sand (save ends). Each time they fail the save, they take 1d6 damage. 12-16 The creature is restrained by the quicksand until the end of their next turn. 17+ The creature can move 2 squares. A non-grappled creature who enters the quicksand or starts their turn in it must make the Agility RR. If you are not touching the ground, roll for a different backlash.
65-66	You open a one-way viewing portal that follows you around wherever you go until the end of this DT. You can't sense anything on the other side of the portal, but anyone on the other side can see and hear through the portal. The other side of the portal appears near a personal enemy or rival of the Ref's choice.
67-68	You teleport up to 50 squares away in a horizontal direction chosen by the Ref into an unoccupied space.
69-70	You take 1d6 damage and become encased in earth from the neck down and are restrained. Another creature must use an action to free you. Each time you start a combat round encased in earth, you take 1d6 damage.

d100 + Rank	Backlash
71-72	If the effect of the spell is good, you cast it and target the nearest enemy, regardless of the spell's range. If the effect of the spell is bad, you cast it and target yourself, regardless of the spell's range. The Ref determines if the spell is good or bad.
73-74	You get a full feeling in your stomach. At the start of each of your turns in combat, you must roll any die. On an odd result, you spend the turn vomiting slugs and can do nothing else. This effect has 1 UD.
75-76	The Ref randomly chooses 1d6 × 100 coins or a gem or other mundane treasure that you carry. It melts.
77-78	You transform into a frog. Your size is Tiny, your Stamina maximum is reduced to 1, you have 0 slots, and you lose all your skills. You have a climb and swim speed equal to your walking speed and Jump +2. This effect has 1 UD.
79-80	Shuffle your inventory cards into a deck. Roll a d10. Then pull a number of cards equal to the result from the top of the deck. The last card pulled is a piece of equipment that is teleported off your person into a dungeon of the Ref's choice.
81-82	Your mouth and ears meld shut until you finish a rest. During this time, you can't speak or hear anything.
83-84	Your eyes become light sensitive. You treat bright light as if it were darkness. This effect has 2 UD.
85-86	You summon a cloud of buzzing, stinging insects that follow you around and don't allow you to rest until you feed them 1,000 pounds of flesh.
87-88	Your Strength score decreases by 1 until you finish a rest. This effect is cumulative.
89-90	Your Agility score decreases by 1 until you finish a rest. This effect is cumulative.

d100 + Rank	Backlash
91-92	Your Mind score decreases by 1 until you finish a rest. This effect is cumulative.
93-94	Magic bursts forth from inside your body, causing you to suffer 1d6 wounds.
95-96	Lightning flies from your body. You and each creature within 5 squares of you takes 3d6 damage.
97-98	You become allergic to magic. Whenever you or any creature activates a magic item or casts a spell within 10 squares of you, you take 1d6 P damage. This effect has 2 UD.
99-100	Whenever you cast a spell, the result is treated as one tier lower. If you get a tier 1 result, it is treated as a doom. This effect has 2 UD.
101	Antlers grow from your head. If you cut these off, they instantly grow back. You can't wear hats or any type of headgear that isn't specially modified to fit your new noggin.
102	Your mind is warped by magic. The Ref randomly chooses a skill in which you have at least a +1 bonus and a skill in which you have no bonus. You lose the bonus to the skill you have and gain it in the skill you do not.
103	Magic within your body reshapes one of your hands into a deadly weapon. The Ref randomly chooses a mundane 1-handed weapon. Your hand is now this weapon. You can't ever use that hand slot to hold another object.
104	Magic lightning wracks your body with pain. Your Stamina is reduced to 0 and you gain 2d6 wounds.
105	A portal to Hell opens beneath you and sucks you into it as a chorus of demons laughs at your unfortunate fate. The portal shuts as your soul and body are forever sealed away.

SUMMONED CREATURES

Some spells allow you to summon creatures. Unless specified otherwise, these creatures do as you command. They function like pets in combat except that you don't need to make a test to convince them to undertake dangerous actions.

[Hold for edits and diagrams of spell cards]

Crafting

While you rest or are in town, you can use to craft new equipment.

Crafting Prerequisites

You must meet an item's prerequisites to craft it.

- **Skill:** Every craftable item has a skill and bonus associated with it. You must have the appropriate skill bonus in the skill to craft it. This prerequisite is on the item's card.
- **Materials:** Every craftable item requires raw materials. This prerequisite is on the item's card.
- **Recipe:** Every craftable item has a document of instructions to follow for crafting it. If you skill bonus in the prerequisite skill is higher than the item's prerequisite bonus, then you don't need a recipe to craft it.
- **Tools:** See below.

Tools

The tools you need to craft an item are based on the skill needed to craft the item.

- **Alchemy:** Alchemist's tools
- **Blacksmithing:** Blacksmith's tools
- **Enchanting:** Enchanter's tools

Harvesting Materials

Some crafting materials must be harvested from a monster corpse with the Harvest rest activity. Each corpse can only provide 1 of a specific body part, such as blood, heart, or hide. You can only harvest 1 body part per rest activity, though multiple PCs can harvest body parts from the same corpse during a rest. Monster blood and organs are Tiny objects. Monster hides are one size smaller than the creature they come from.

Crafting Goal

Each craftable item has a crafting goal, a special number, listed on its card. The higher the number, the longer it takes to make the item.

Crafting Rolls

You can take the Craft Equipment rest activity to craft a piece of equipment you meet the prerequisites for. When you do, you make a crafting roll when you finish the rest.

A crafting roll is a special Mind test that uses the item's prerequisite skill and doesn't have tiered outcomes. Instead, you calculate the total and record the result. When you make a crafting roll, the total—no matter how low—becomes crafting points that are accrued by the item you're creating. Even if you have a penalty on a crafting roll, the minimum total for the roll is 1, unless you get a doom result. If you get a doom result on a crafting roll, you accrue no new points for the item. If you obtain a crit on a crafting roll, you can make another crafting roll for the same item as part of the same rest activity.

When all of an item's crafting points equal or are greater than its crafting goal, the item is complete and the materials used to create it are expended.

Multiple Crafters

If an creature taking a rest with you meets the tool and skill prerequisites for an item you are crafting with the Craft Equipment activity, they can use their rest activity to undertake the task with you. Crafting rolls they make as part of this rest activity are accrued by the item as points.

Identifying Magic Items

When you encounter an unfamiliar magic item, you don't know automatically know its properties, but you can tell that it is magical, as all such items vibrate with power. To discover an item's properties, you can ask an NPC who has expertise with the item, such as asking an alchemist about a potion, or use the Identify Item rest activity during a rest. You could attempt to activate the item and see what happens. If the item is a liquid in a vial, you might drink it or pour it out on the ground to observe any effect. If it's a sword, you might swing it at a foe and see what happens. This method could waste a consumable item or have disastrous effects if the item is cursed or not fit for human consumption.

If you want to identify a magic item you hold, you can also make the following test.

2d10 + M

- ⚔11 You accidentally activate the item in a harmful way determined by the Ref.
- 12-16 You learn nothing about the item.
- 17+ You learn all of the item's properties.

You can only make this test once with an item.